the border, including visits by prominent Americans on both sides of the divided city. Then the chapter looks at how Davis develops and delivers the wall as a symbol, throughout the course of her writing in multiple projects and culminating in the autobiography. Finally, the chapter looks to both the production and the circulation of her autobiography, to place this reference into a broader framework of Davis's transitional activism and solidarity through circuits of alternative diplomacy. Davis does so by gesturing to but not naming Berlin's barrier, in an effort to maintain her allegiances to the GDR. She transforms the Berlin Wall from a spectacle to be viewed from the West to a symbol of Western repression. By the time she returns to East Berlin after her trial, she eventually treats the Wall as invisible altogether. In doing so, she inverts the expected tale of intrigue, danger, and despair in East Berlin toward her own political projects contesting American division.

To contextualize Davis's involvement in the representations of East and West Berlin beginning in the mid-1960s, one can look to the complex geography of divided Berlin, especially for Americans. Throughout the 1960s, the persistence of American and allied involvement in Berlin aimed to recalibrate diplomatic and military ties throughout all four controlled zones of Berlin. The incorporation of East Berlin into a Western sense of the full city was fueled by the desire by Western allies to maintain a political position of direct access to the Soviet Sector of Berlin, as per the 1945 agreements of the city's occupation. The Wall's construction served at first as provocation toward standoff and then ultimately produced a stalemate to curtail and direct tension to the border. While civilians could approach and peer over the Wall at observation decks from the West, no mirrored practice took place in the East. As noted, for citizens of the German Democratic Republic, the "Berlin Wall" was forbidden from casual language and, when possible, from sight. Border control was tied to but not limited to the area of the Berlin Wall itself and stood in for a broader system of controlling dissent and difference. As Ladd writes, "Apart from official ceremonies, Easterners were discouraged from approaching the Wall and even taking note of its existence. Those East Berliners who lived in the streets next to the Wall had to adjust to special restrictions, intrusions, and inconveniences. Friends from outside the neighborhood could never just drop by, for example: permission had to be obtained from the police."[16]